

# Order-Sensitive Secular Determinants for an Inhomogeneous Coined Quantum Walk

Hénon Route-A Working Series, C143

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## Abstract

We construct a spatially inhomogeneous two-state coined quantum walk on a five-cycle. Rational reflection coins and a flip-flop shift give a source-derived real unitary  $U = SC$  with involutive antiunitary reversal  $\Theta = CK$ . Its trace expansion retains signed primitive path amplitudes. Two coin arrangements with the same local population but different spatial order have distinct degree-ten secular polynomials; their difference factors exactly. Population averaging both erases this distinction and destroys unitarity. The result reaches a unitary Route-A subgate but makes no arithmetic or target spectral identification.

## 1 Frozen coined dynamics

On  $\mathcal{H} = \mathbb{C}^5 \otimes \mathbb{C}^2$ , order the basis as  $(0, +), (0, -), \dots, (4, +), (4, -)$ . Freeze the real reflection coins

$$C_0 = \frac{1}{5} \begin{pmatrix} 3 & 4 \\ 4 & -3 \end{pmatrix}, \quad C_1 = \frac{1}{13} \begin{pmatrix} 5 & 12 \\ 12 & -5 \end{pmatrix}.$$

For a spatial word  $w = w_0 \cdots w_4$ , let  $C_w = \bigoplus_x C_{w_x}$ . The flip-flop shift is

$$S|x, +\rangle = |x+1, -\rangle, \quad S|x, -\rangle = |x-1, +\rangle,$$

with positions modulo five. One coin-then-shift step is  $U_w = SC_w$ . This convention, clock, basis, and the determinant  $D_w(z) = \det(I_{10} - zU_w)$  are fixed before comparison.

## 2 Unitary and antiunitary structure

**Theorem 1.** *For every  $w$ ,  $U_w$  is real orthogonal. With  $K$  denoting coefficientwise conjugation, the antiunitary  $\Theta_w = C_w K$  obeys*

$$\Theta_w^2 = I, \quad \Theta_w U_w \Theta_w^{-1} = U_w^{-1}.$$

*Moreover  $P_w = |U_w|^2$  is doubly stochastic and has the same one-step support and clock.*

*Proof.* Each displayed coin is real symmetric and squares to  $I$ ; the real symmetric permutation  $S$  also satisfies  $S^2 = I$ . Therefore  $U_w^* U_w = C_w S S C_w = I$ . Since  $K$  fixes both real matrices,

$$(C_w K)^2 = C_w^2 = I, \quad \text{quad}(C_w K)(SC_w)(KC_w) = C_w S = U_w^{-1}.$$

The row and column sums of squared moduli of a unitary are one. □

This antiunitary is source-derived from the same local coin that defines the evolution; it is not added after examining the determinant.

### 3 Signed primitive path ownership

A directed state path carries the product of the corresponding entries of  $U_w$ , including every sign. For a primitive cycle  $p$ , write its step clock as  $\ell_p$  and signed amplitude as  $A_p$ .

**Proposition 1.** For  $|z| < 5/7$ ,

$$D_w(z) = \prod_{[p]} (1 - A_p z^{\ell_p}), \quad (1)$$

where  $[p]$  runs over primitive directed state cycles. The left side gives the global polynomial continuation; no raw-product convergence outside the displayed disk is asserted.

*Proof.* Expanding  $-\log D_w(z) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \text{Tr}(U_w^n) z^n / n$  enumerates rooted closed paths with signed amplitudes. Primitive-root decomposition and cyclic invariance of an amplitude product give (1). Every column of  $|U_w|$  has sum at most  $7/5$ , so the total absolute rooted-path mass is bounded by  $10(7/5)^n$ . This proves absolute convergence on the stated disk and justifies regrouping without discarding cancellations.  $\square$

### 4 Equal populations, different determinants

Compare

$$w = 00011, qquad v = 00101.$$

Both have population  $(N_0, N_1) = (3, 2)$ , but they are not related by a cyclic rotation or a reflection followed by rotation: the two 1 symbols are adjacent on the cycle for  $w$  and nonadjacent for  $v$ , a dihedral invariant. Writing  $D(z) = \sum_{k=0}^{10} d_k z^k$ , exact Newton recursion

$$k d_k = - \sum_{j=1}^k d_{k-j} \text{Tr}(U^j), \quad d_0 = 1,$$

gives

$$\begin{aligned} D_w(z) &= 1 + \frac{5617}{4225} z^2 + \frac{6798}{4225} z^4 - \frac{18432}{21125} z^5 + \frac{6798}{4225} z^6 + \frac{5617}{4225} z^8 + z^{10}, \\ D_v(z) &= 1 + \frac{417}{325} z^2 + \frac{538}{325} z^4 - \frac{18432}{21125} z^5 + \frac{538}{325} z^6 + \frac{417}{325} z^8 + z^{10}. \end{aligned}$$

Consequently

$$D_w - D_v = \frac{196}{4225} z^2 (z-1)^2 (z+1)^2 (z^2+1) \neq 0. \quad (2)$$

Spatial coin order is therefore visible to the exact determinant.

Both polynomials are palindromic. Indeed,  $S$  is a product of five transpositions and  $C_w$  of five reflections, so  $\det U_w = 1$ ; real orthogonality then gives  $D_w(z) = z^{10} D_w(1/z)$ . This finite source symmetry is not a target functional equation.

### 5 Why population averaging is invalid

The seemingly natural averaged coin is

$$\overline{C} = \frac{3C_0 + 2C_1}{5} = \frac{1}{325} \begin{pmatrix} 167 & 276 \\ 276 & -167 \end{pmatrix}.$$

It satisfies

$$\overline{C}^T \overline{C} - I = -\frac{24}{1625} I, qquad \det \overline{C} = -\frac{1601}{1625}.$$

Thus averaging destroys unitarity as well as order. It is a negative control, not an alternative representation of either walk.

## 6 Exact receipt and scope

For each arrangement the evidence reconstructs 12 traces and every signed rooted path through clock ten; at clock ten there are 1,270 rooted closed paths and 125 primitive cycles. The producer-independent checker makes 62 assertions, a separate SymPy route makes 39 exact checks, replay is byte-identical, and 29 repaired-hash plus one stale-hash mutations are rejected.

The strict verdict is

(A1\_WEAK, A2\_FAIL, A3\_FAIL, A4\_UNITARY\_OR\_SCATTERING\_CANDIDATE).

There is no target divisor, missing/extra-zero census, target counting law, prime correspondence, arithmetic local factor, Euler factor, root number, automorphy claim, or self-adjoint Hilbert–Pólya operator. The dimension is fixed and no growing-level limit is claimed. Route B remains unauthorized under NO\_BAD\_EULER\_OR\_ROOT\_NUMBER.

## 7 Conclusion

C143 shows that one source-derived discrete unitary can retain chronological spatial order, signed orbit amplitudes, and exact reversal simultaneously. Connecting this finite walk to any external target remains open.